



MONTHLY UPDATE

Algeria: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27-2 · 40 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

The state inaugurated its own data-centre estate on 5 July and gave administrations one month to interconnect to it; the apostille legalisation platform opened on 9 July; the national services portal acquired a telephone helpline on 29 July. Three further instruments passed through a single Council of Government sitting on 23 July — renewal of both incumbent GSM licences by executive decree, a national information-verification system, and an accreditation and conformity network — and none of the three has a published text.

The Ministry of Foreign Trade and Export Promotion announced on 27 July that from 1 August applications to import services must be lodged, processed and tracked exclusively through a new platform, with [no fallback or assisted channel stated](#).

Nothing moved on the ethical-AI law, the domestic instant-payment system or the universal-service build. The National AI Strategy moved after July closed: a [joint inter-ministerial roadmap for deploying artificial intelligence across public services was agreed and reported on 12 August](#), the text of the strategy still unpublished.

August's own additions run the same way — platforms delivered, foundations undeclared. Two more services opened, a [complaints platform for economic operators](#) and an [Ombudsman videoconference reception to be piloted from September](#); the unified national digital identity was shown [working as single sign-on for a sectoral platform](#); and the interior minister [described his own ministry's vehicle-registration and civil-status digitisation as stalled](#).

Governance

Legislation and regulation

The electronic commerce law is in force and, on a consumer body's assessment, largely bypassed: [the great majority of online selling runs through social-media pages outside its obligations, with cash on delivery dominant](#). That is named-analyst opinion rather than a state position; the law's own date and text are not held, and no enforcement action or compliance figure is on file. Separately a [national information-verification system was examined in draft by the Council of Government on 23 July](#), with no regulator, legal basis or oversight mechanism named in anything held. On 14 August the telecommunications ministry [asked Meta to require every WhatsApp account to stay linked to a verified national mobile number](#), rejecting the username-only accounts introduced in June 2026 and citing fraud, identity theft and cybercrime prevention. It is a request rather than an instrument; no order, deadline or sanction is stated, and the platform-regulation bill deposited in October 2025 remains undebated.

Data protection

The data-protection authority adopted a deliberation on 15 July holding that any photograph or video permitting direct or indirect identification of a natural person is personal data, so its collection, storage, retention and publication need a legal basis. Publishing images on platforms whose infrastructure is hosted outside Algeria [may constitute an international transfer](#), triggering the adequacy obligations of articles 44–45. The deliberation's own number, text and commencement are not held; the capture is a press account of it.

One further governance event changed nothing: the national police held a [study day on 1 July](#) tying data protection to national security, with the authority present. It names no instrument.

Regional collaboration

Algeria [signed as a founding member of a world artificial-intelligence organisation at Shanghai on 16 July](#), the digitalisation commissioner stating an intention to take an active role. The organisation is not named in anything held, and no accord text, ratification step or work programme is on file.

Standards

Progress on a national accreditation, conformity and certification network and its GEOLAB platform was reviewed at the 23 July Council of Government sitting.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

On 26 July Algeria and Oman [discussed digital cooperation](#) across artificial intelligence, data centres, fintech and space, with the Omani ministry and the Oman Investment Authority offering flexible partnership arrangements. No instrument was concluded at the meeting, so it stands as planned.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

IPv6 generalisation was [launched on 14 July](#).

On 23 July the Council of Government examined draft executive decrees renewing the public cellular licences held by Mobilis and Optimum Telecom Algérie (Djezzy). Renewal by executive decree places licence continuation with the cabinet rather than with the regulator, which ran the 5G round as a competitive tender. No term, fee, coverage obligation or decree text is held, and the Prime Minister's own communiqué of the sitting is not on file — the account rests on [one press carry](#).

Data Storage

The National Digital Services Centre was inaugurated by President Tebboune on 5 July: [two active-active sites at Mohammadia and Blida](#), built by Huawei to Uptime Tier III design, with 99.98% availability claimed by the operator. On 12 July administrations were ordered to interconnect to it [within one month](#). The national sovereign cloud is hosted there; no service catalogue and no tenant list is held, which is why its position is recorded without a baseline rather than as an advance.

Cybersecurity

The cybersecurity record this window is a warning about the state's own brand rather than about its systems. The Algiers wilaya [told citizens that unlicensed platforms are impersonating its institutions and public enterprises, mostly as fake e-ticketing storefronts built to harvest bank card details and personal data, and directed them to check the domain name before paying and to use only officially approved portals](#). It is a communique, not an enforcement action: no takedown, prosecution or count of impersonating sites is on record. The exposure it describes tracks the payment figures in the section below — more web merchants and more card use give a counterfeit storefront more to imitate.

DPI

Data Exchange

Interconnection acquired a deadline before it acquired its rules. A think tank's first digital brief records that the [president gave the sectors one month from 12 July to interconnect through the national data centre](#), and nothing has been reported against that date. The two referentiels the interoperability decree makes the obligations wait on are still untraced, so the instrument that would carry the interconnection remains unenforceable while the timetable for it has already run.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The unified national digital identity is being used as a single sign-on, and the record's first evidence of that is a sectoral one. On 12 August the sports ministry [integrated its platforms into the national services portal so that holders of the credential reach its WADHIFATI platform without registering again](#). The credential is issued by the Haut Commissariat a la Numerisation; no enrolment count, assurance level, governing instrument or data-protection basis for it is held, so what a reader can establish is that it works across two systems, not how many people hold it or on what legal footing.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The Bank of Algeria hosted the [29th ordinary meeting of the Arab Commission for Payment and Settlement Systems](#) in Algiers on 27 July. No instrument was concluded.

Registries

Two registry developments pulled in opposite directions. The education ministry [ordered its wilaya directorates and schools to accept electronically issued civil-status documents and stop demanding paper copies](#), warning staff that unjustified refusal engages their responsibility “an obligation inside one ministry rather than a general rule. On vehicle registration the interior minister [called for rapid correction of technical problems and malfunctions](#) in the system, with no fault description, backlog figure or completion date given.

Sectoral management information systems

A pilot arrived on 30 July: SEAAL signed an MoU with OTEC and Omantel for [automated water-meter reading](#) on a LoRaWAN network, with no site, scale or start date stated.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The apostille platform went live on [9 July](#), following Algeria's accession to the Hague Convention on 25 August 2025, with recognition claimed in about 126 states. It was planned at accession and implemented at launch.

The national single window gained a free helpline, 3017, from [29 July](#), open seven days a week. The same account puts the portal at 21 live services in 2026-07 against targets of 62 by end-2027 and 350 by 2028.

A second national portal was announced on 24 July: the Ministry of Labour, Employment and Social Security will consolidate its attached bodies behind one electronic portal, reporting [235 services delivered online in 2026-07](#) and 97% document digitisation in 2026-04, and targeting 50% more online procedures by December 2026. No interoperability with the national portal is stated.

The services-import platform announced on 27 July becomes the exclusive route from 1 August. Nothing held confirms it in operation.

August added two more, and one admission. The trade ministry's [complaints platform for economic operators went live on 11 August](#), for remote filing and tracking of concerns about import and export procedures, and the ministry describes it as the fifth platform it has put into service this year. The Ombudsman institution will [pilot a videoconference citizen-reception service from September 2026](#), to ease access for citizens in remote areas and people with specific needs. Against that, on 10 August the interior minister [ordered his own ministry to accelerate digitisation projects he described as stalled](#), naming vehicle-registration and civil-status services, at a review held under presidential instructions to speed cross-sector interconnection. He does not say in what respect they have stalled, and gives no completion figure or revised timetable.

The state fuel distributor [made its e-Mahata platform the single window for ordering tyres](#), requiring electronic payment and capping one make at two purchases per citizen per six months – a rationing rule enforced through an identity-bound ordering platform rather than at the counter. Separately, the labour ministry [launched an online corruption-reporting platform, Tabligh](#), covering the central administration, with no report volume, handling procedure or protection for reporters published.

Technology

AI

On 25 July the Higher Education Minister announced that from the 2026–2027 academic year each student's learning pathway will be steered by an intelligent assistant matching modules to competences and career goals, alongside a large language model for lecturers that generates teaching material and [marks student answers](#). No appeal route, accuracy claim, disclosure duty or human-review threshold is reported. The figures given alongside are the minister's own, delivered in a speech, and none is independently sourced.

The strategy itself moved in August rather than July. A [joint inter-ministerial roadmap was agreed to deploy artificial intelligence across public services, prioritising sovereign open-source models, high-performance computing centres, national data storage and stronger safeguards for public-sector applications](#), reported on 12 August by the higher education minister, with intensive university training programmes, a dedicated research centre and specialised research units, and a joint monitoring committee established to oversee delivery against a stated timeline. The strategy text is still not published and the ethical-AI law has not moved.

Three external events are dated in the month and moved nothing. The Post and Telecommunications Minister told the inaugural [UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance](#) in Geneva on 6 July that global governance should move from principles to technology transfer and capacity building. Smart Africa's chief executive met him on [13 July](#) on AI adoption and digital integration; no agreement or commitment is reported. Algérie Télécom received a [WSIS Forum certificate of appreciation](#) on 9 July. The award is a certificate of appreciation; the ministry described it as confirmation of Algeria's standing.

ICT Industry

The state electronics manufacturer was [accredited to install and maintain every payment terminal on national territory whatever its brand or origin](#), widening it from its own-brand devices, against 1.6m terminals produced. The accreditation's own date is not stated — only the report of it.

Innovation ecosystem

The student start-up conversion scheme reports [673 start-ups, 3,949 patents and 2,339 innovative-project labels between 2022 and July 2026](#), against a 2030 target of 5,000 labelled products. It lets students convert final-year projects into start-ups or patents and is supported by a prototype-financing scheme and the country's first venture-capital fund. The ministerial order behind it is not held, neither its date nor its text.

The money attached to the President of the Republic's Prize for the best start-up [was raised by presidential decree 26-277 of 23 August 2026](#), amending article 3 of the founding decree of January. The amounts and the award cycle are set by decree rather than by a programme document.

Inclusion

Access to services

Consumer cloud storage prices were [raised for new subscribers from 27 July 2026](#), in this market alongside two others on the continent. One provider's consumer tariff is thin evidence for affordability, and the account gives no local subscriber base against which to read it. It is recorded because it is the only dated consumer cloud price the base holds here, and a price that moves is more use than a market with no price at all.

Geopolitics

China activities

The country was named a [founding member, from 16 July, of a 29-country artificial-intelligence organisation headquartered in Shanghai](#). No instrument of accession, obligation, contribution or programme of work is on the record here.

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